Toronto Higher Ed Futures Conference 2026

Post-event report | March 21, 2026 | Toronto | virtual education event | Venue: the ConferAtlas Live virtual platform, produced from our Toronto studio

1. Executive summary

The Toronto Higher Ed Futures Conference 2026 welcomed 574 attendees out of 786 confirmed registrations (846 registrations in total), a show-up rate of 73%. Attendees rated the program 3.74 out of 5 on average, for a net promoter score of -19. 9 sponsors took part; 9 of them met their lead target, and sponsors collected 1,031 leads against a combined target of 765. The event cost $75,900 against a budget of $78,000 (-2.7%).

2. Audience

The largest attendee groups were Dean (110), Administrator (103), Teacher (96). Most attendees came from United States (28%), Mexico (14%), Canada (13%).

3. Program highlights

The program ran 9 sessions. The highest-rated sessions were Assessment with Ben Martin (rated 4.30, 187 attendees); Higher Ed with Wen Adams (rated 4.04, 125 attendees); Leadership with Diego Young (rated 3.96, 125 attendees). The lowest-rated session was Higher Ed with Ben Zhang (rated 2.56). A highlight of the event: the new mobile app check-in cut queue times in half.

4. Venue and operations

The main operational issue was that the streaming platform buffered for about 10 minutes during the opening keynote. In response, production switched to the backup encoder and the keynote recording was published the same day.

5. Sponsor results

Sponsor	Package	Leads	Target	Attainment
Corvid Medical	Digital Premier	194	135	144%
Evergrove Capital	Digital Premier	171	135	127%
Cedarline Capital	Digital Premier	163	135	121%
Mosaic Press	Virtual Booth	99	60	165%
Granite Learning	Virtual Booth	88	60	147%
Juniper Capital	Virtual Booth	87	60	145%
Indigo Learning	Virtual Booth	85	60	142%
Halcyon Medical	Virtual Booth	77	60	128%
Sablewood Therapeutics	Virtual Booth	67	60	112%

Sponsor feedback: Sablewood Therapeutics asked for more signage pointing to their booth.

6. Lessons learned

Lesson: popular breakout rooms were overcrowded. Recommendation for the next edition: cap breakout room registration at 80% of capacity and stream overflow sessions.